



Ezaz Shaikh

Gameplay & Systems Designer

India GDC Game Awards 2025
PC/Console Game of the Year Nominee

Tokyo Games Show 2025
Selected Indie 80 Nominee

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India

Socials

LinkedIn
Ezaz Shaikh

Languages

English
Full Professional (C1/C2)

Hindi
Native/Bilingual (C2)

Shipped Titles

Core Trials (2025)

Motion-based Pixel-art **bullet hell roguelike** you play with just your webcam.

PC

Move Match 3D (2024)

Match 3D where you collect identical items with your body to meet the goals in time.

Android iOS WebGL

Drift Up (2024)

Endless runner where you shield a fragile balloon with your body as a protector.

Android

Move Or Not (2023)

Hyper-casual puzzle where you decode expressions and move your body to select the answer.

Android iOS

Experience

Feb 2026 - Present

Remote

VTX Games

Freelance Game Designer

Leading design, development, and art direction for therapeutic game experiences built for adults navigating PTSD, Parkinson's, and related conditions, translating clinical accessibility needs into tight-scoped, fully accessible gameplay.

- Designed **no-fail gameplay structures** and **diegetic-only feedback systems** to reduce anxiety and support therapeutic comfort.
- Built **accessible UX flows** grounded in cognitive load reduction for players with neurological and psychological conditions.
- Established **core design pillars** for design: no-fail architecture, diegetic feedback, contextual realism, and system simplicity.

Jan 2026 - April 2026

Remote

Raviosoft Studio

Game Designer

Collaborated with a cross-functional design team to architect core gameplay systems for an unannounced Action-Adventure RPG under NDA.

- Participated in **cross-functional design meetings**, contributing to discussions around gameplay direction and art style alignment.
- Observed **system planning and production workflows** to understand large-scope RPG development processes.
- Supported early-stage **design exploration and documentation**.

Apr 2023 - Sep 2025

Jaipur, Rajasthan

Ohilo Games

Lead Game Designer

Led design and production for an indie team shipping multi-platform motion games (iOS, Android, WebGL, PC), surpassing 50,000+ downloads and 500+ player reviews with average ratings above 4 stars.

- Designed and prototyped 50+ mechanics and 10+ gameplay systems**, refining core loops through playtesting and iteration.
- Designed and balanced 100+ puzzle levels and 15+ combat levels**, supporting varied player segments and difficulty scaling.
- Owned end-to-end UX flow (60+ screens)**, from wireframes to UI implementation with responsive feedback and animation polish.
- Translated community feedback, **data from analytics and A/B testing into actionable design updates**.

Jan 2023 - Mar 2023

Remote

Valarsoft

Game Design Intern

Applied game design principles to 3 non-gaming apps, creating gamified systems under NDA constraints.

- Designed a room decorator mini-game** (5+ environments, 50+ items) and a **construction game economy** with 30+ item types.
- Prototyped a 10-page Cinderella-like visual novel**, combining traditional scripting with early AI-assisted tools to speed up iterations.
- Authored clear, **implementation-ready design documents** translating brainstorming concepts into structured product flows.

Skills

Core Expertise

- Systems
- Gameplay

Rapid Prototyping & Iteration

- Core Loop
- Retention Design
- Game Balance

Player Psychology

Systems & Content

Level Design

Content Design

- Game Analysis
- Reverse Engineering

UX-Focused UI

Production & Implementation

Structured Documentation

- Unity Technical Setup
- Gameplay Polish

Cross-Platform Release Management

Toolset

Unity
Game Engine

VS Code
IDE

DOTween
Animation

Git
Version Control

Figma
Design

Spreadsheet
Management

Photoshop
Design

Xcode
Publishing

Play Console
Publishing

Education

Ajeenkya D Y Patil University, Pune

B.Sc. Gaming | Gold Medalist | 9.26 CGPA

2020-2023